

A Self-Closing Gate Conundrum

#1 Victory Royale

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Student G's family needs a self-closing mechanism that closes their family's gate on its own because his family does not want unwanted animals and people to get inside their fence gate because it is a safety concern that could cause injury. This happens because student G's gate can not close on its own.

The people involved in this problem are student G's parents, his sister, himself, his dog, and their gardening crews. Other people who have a fence that might not close on its own are Mr. C (the agriculture teacher), the baseball athletes and coaches at our school, construction crews, other sports teams, and the general public. These people are all having trouble closing the gate at where they live, work, at school etc. This is happening at student G's house, at our school, and at other people's houses. This usually occurs when anyone has to leave and enter his house, when the baseball athletes and coaches enter the field at our school, when anyone who has a fence that doesn't close on its own uses their fence.

Solving this problem could impact the stakeholder by helping them when they carry groceries inside, when they let their pet outside, when kids forget to close the gate, when they are tired and do not want to close it on their own. Solving this problem could lead to unintended consequences by pinching a body part between the fence and the gate. You could also cause an injury by the gate hitting you when it closes on its own.

The Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) is aware of 22 deaths that happened between January 1, 2008 and January 7, 2020 regarding gates. The CPSC has also recognized

456 nonfatal incidents between January 1, 2008 and January 7, 2020. A 9 year old girl passed away on November 17, 2023 after a metal gate fell on her at her local elementary school.

It is important to solve this problem now because almost everytime student G's family goes outside and opens the gate they forget to close it and unwanted animals get inside of the gate and mess up their yard. It is a problem that needs to be solved because constant repairs to student G's house costs a lot of money over time. This is also important because student G's family does not want to get unwanted injuries in regards to their gate.

Works Cited

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